

the immersion it talked about. But then there were some people who were confused. Why was this idea brought back? Wasn't its last failure enough?

The Pre-Oculus virtual reality

The idea of a virtual reality headset was first presented in a 1935 short story, *Pygmalion's Spectacles* by Stanley G. Weinbaum. The science fiction story describes a goggle-based system which enables wearers to witness fictional experiences along with touch and smell. Then in 1962, cinematographer Morton Heilig created *Sensorama*. It was an arcade-style theatre cabinet which was capable of showcasing films along with smell, vibrations and wind.

The first time the world saw a head-mounted VR display was in 1968. Ivan Sutherland and his student Bob Sproull created what they called "The Ultimate Display". It was so heavy that it had to be suspended from the ceiling. The appearance of this device gave it the name "The Sword of Damocles" and it was only capable of rendering basic wireframe content.

In 1987 Jaron Lanier coined the term "virtual reality" when through his company he created *EyePhone* and *Dataglove*. The *EyePhone* was a head-mounted display unit which could be controlled by the *Dataglove*.



One of Virtual Reality's earliest forms